

Profile

Personal information

Name	Chepchumba, Faith
Share different name	No
Birthdate	02/11/2003

Contact details

Email, Phone	chepchumbafaithfaith@gmail.com, +254.798187304, Mobile, No other telephone
Permanent address	Uhuru Rd Kericho, Kericho, KEN
Alternate address	BOX 134 KERICHO KERICHO, Rift Valley, 20200, KEN

Demographics

Gender Identity	Female
Sex	Female
Pronouns	She/Her
Military status	None
Hispanic or Latino/a/x	No
Race	Black or African American (Africa)

Language

English	Speak, Read, Write, Spoken at Home
Swahili	First Language, Speak, Read, Write, Spoken at Home
French	Speak, Read, Write
Other, Kipsigis	Speak, Read

Geography and nationality

Citizenship status	Citizen of non-U.S. country
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Birthplace	Kericho, Kenya 0 years US
Other citizenships	Kenya
Current US Visa	None
Intended US Visa	F-1 Student

Common App fee waiver

Fee waiver requested	Yes, Signed: FAITH CHEPCHUMBA
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Family

Household

Parents	Married
Home	Both Parents

Parent 1

Mother

Name	Mrs. Sharon C Terer (Chumo)
Email, Phone	sharontererr@gmail.com, +254.715607698, Mobile
Occupation	Other, Small-scale farmer, Unemployed
Education	Completed grade/primary school

Parent 2

Father

Name	Mr. Samwel C Terer
Email, Phone	sterer099@gmail.com, +254.112319152, Mobile
Occupation	Laborer, Unemployed
Education	Graduated from high/secondary school (or equivalent)

Siblings

Patience Chebet, Age 19
Lynn Terer, Age 18

Education

Current or most recent secondary school

Loreto High School Limuru, Kiambu, Central, Kenya, Public (01/2017 - 04/2021)

Boarding school	Yes: Living at school
Progression	Did or will take gap year
Graduation Date	04/2021

Colleges & universities

Grades

Rank	3 / 267, Unweighted
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Current or most recent year courses

First trimester	Second trimester	Third trimester
MATH - Mathematics Alternative B - (ADV)	MATH - Mathematics Alternative B - (ADV)	MATH - Mathematics Alternative B - (ADV)
ENG - English & Literature - (ADV)	ENG - English & Literature - (ADV)	ENG - English & Literature - (ADV)
LANG - Swahili & Swahili Literature - (ADV)	LANG - Swahili & Swahili Literature - (ADV)	LANG - Swahili & Swahili Literature - (ADV)
BIOL - Biology - (ADV)	BIOL - Biology - (ADV)	BIOL - Biology - (ADV)
CHEM - Chemistry - (ADV)	CHEM - Chemistry - (ADV)	CHEM - Chemistry - (ADV)
PHYS - Physics - (ADV)	PHYS - Physics - (ADV)	PHYS - Physics - (ADV)
RELG - Christian Religious Education - (ADV)	RELG - Christian Religious Education - (ADV)	RELG - Christian Religious Education - (ADV)
LANG - French - (ADV)	LANG - French - (ADV)	LANG - French - (ADV)

Honors

First Runners-Up, Inter-switch SPAK Final round in Nigeria 2019	School, State/Regional, National, International	11
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Winner of the Young Scientists of Kenya 3rd National Science & Technology Fair	School, State/Regional, National	11
Winner of the World Scholar's Cup: The Hague 2019 Global Round, Third Runners-Up- TOC at Yale	School, State/Regional, National, International	11
Winner of 2020/2021 Innovate Kenya-Robotics Category	School, State/Regional, National, International	11, 12
Valedictorian- DELF B2 Exam (2019) & DELF C1 Exam (2021) at Alliance Française	School, State/Regional, National, International	11, Post-graduate

Future plans

Scientific researcher, Doctorate

Testing

Leaving Exams

Mathematics	A	03/2021, Actual, Kenya Certificate of Secondary Education (KCSE)
English & Literature	B+	03/2021, Actual, Kenya Certificate of Secondary Education (KCSE)
Kiswahili & Literature	A-	03/2021, Actual, Kenya Certificate of Secondary Education (KCSE)
Biology	A-	03/2021, Actual, Kenya Certificate of Secondary Education (KCSE)
Chemistry	A	03/2021, Actual, Kenya Certificate of Secondary Education (KCSE)
Physics	A-	03/2021, Actual, Kenya Certificate of Secondary Education (KCSE)
Christian Religious Education	A-	03/2021, Actual, Kenya Certificate of Secondary Education (KCSE)
French	A	03/2021, Actual, Kenya Certificate of Secondary Education (KCSE)

Activities

Research

9, 10, 11, 12
School
7 hr/wk, 27 wk/yr
Continue

President & Student Researcher, Science Congress & STEM Club
AQUADUCCT Project won first place at the Young Scientists Kenya 3rd National Science & Technology Fair. Won 2 inter-school Science Congresses.

Robotics

10, 11, 12, PG
Year
3 hr/wk, 24 wk/yr
Continue

Vice President, Robotics & Technovation Club
Programmed a working Chess AI. Designed & programmed a working Soccer Robot; Won first place at '19 & '20 Innovate Kenya competition.

Work (Paid)

12, PG
Year
3 hr/wk, 7 wk/yr
Continue

Assistant Programmer, iEarn Kenya
Assisted in designing the iEarn website. Managed social media accounts. Incharge of desk inquiries. Taught JavaScript at UNESCO events.

Other Club/Activity

11, 12
School
14 hr/wk, 8 wk/yr

President, World Scholar's Cup
Won The Hague 2019 Global Round. Third runners-up at the Tournament of Champions (2019). Won the 2020 Nairobi regional round. Garnered over 30 medals.

Music: Instrumental

9, 10, 11
School
5 hr/wk, 9 wk/yr
Continue

Pianist, School Band & Choir
Won 3 solo pianocompetitions & 2 Band competitions at the National Music Festivals. Performed for The Former President at Kakamega State House.

Athletics: JV/Varsity

10, 11, 12
School
4 hr/wk, 6 wk/yr
Continue

Swim, New Recruit's trainer & Team First Aider, Loreto Swim & Dive Team
Fastest freestyle (28s per 50m) and Butterfly Stroke swimmer. 2- time champion at the East Africa Championships. 3-time champion at Inter-school event

Internship

10, 11, 12, PG
Break
2 hr/wk, 14 wk/yr
Continue

Student Researcher, Research Club Africa
Organized 3 inter-club competitions in Africa. Published AQUADUCCT & Soccer Robot research paper.

Student Govt./Politics

9, 10, 11, 12
School
3 hr/wk, 16 wk/yr
Continue

Ombudsman, Loreto School Government
Served for 2 academic years. Elected President of Student Government, Kiambu county. Elected Speaker of Student Government, Kenya.

Community Service (Volunteer)

11, 12, PG
Year
2 hr/wk, 10 wk/yr
Continue

Founder & President, Elevate The Girl Child, Kericho
Received President's Award for Community service '19 & '20. Speaker at UNESCO & UNICEF school events. Organized 2 campaigns against FGM & GBV.

Religious

9, 10, 11, 12, PG
Year
5 hr/wk, 35 wk/yr
Continue

Choir director, Sunday School Teacher, Christian Union(CU), Legion of Mary(LOM), Deliverance Church Kericho(DCK)
Pianist & soprano soloist for church choir-CU Conducted recitation of the Rosary daily-LOM. Taught Sunday school every Sunday-DCK.

Writing

Personal essay

The lessons we take from obstacles we encounter can be fundamental to later success. Recount a time when you faced a challenge, setback, or failure. How did it affect you, and what did you learn from the experience?

Farmer Lloyd Olsen of Fruita, Colorado, was planning to have a sumptuous dinner with his mother-in-law. He went out to the yard to slaughter a chicken and chose a five-and-a-half-month-old Wyandotte chicken named Mike. In his haste to chop off the bulk of the neck with the head, Mr. Olsen missed the jugular vein leaving most of the brain stem intact. He failed to decapitate Mike. Dramatically, the chicken shrugged off this attempt at its life and never looked back. It is narrated that in the intervening eighteen months of Mike's life, the semi-headless "thing" continued to eat, drink, and even attempted to make crowing sounds. At its prime, Mike was valued at \$10,000. No one has ever tried to chop off my head, but some experiences have made me see Mike as the alter ego of my very eventful life.

In February 2008, my friends and I were playing gaily at the communal playground. Suddenly, a cascade of loud bangs could be heard from a distance. They were accompanied by mass howling and screaming. Mother rushed out of the house and ordered us inside. Like a groundhog, she piled every piece of furniture that was either bulky or heavy by the doors and windows. The feeling of sheer helplessness engulfed me. The drama of post-election violence had come to Kericho. When I caught a whiff of the tear gas stench, it infiltrated my eyes and urged me inside before they started to sting. The reign of terror, curfews, and martial law became the norm.

Former friendly neighbors suddenly became indifferent to each other. Many people died. I could not play in the communal ground anymore, if I did, they would remind me of Wanjiru, my playmate. She was burned alive by a mob from my tribe. A part of my childhood died that day and I was filled with self-blame. I resented calling myself a Kispsigis. After nine and a half years, the sense of my loss and trauma was real. The monsters of guilt, fear, and despair were huge. However, like a movie playing in slow motion, things started going back to "normal." I decided the answer to grief and guilt was to understand why this happened to Wanjiru. I began to analyze the events and actions that led to the upheaval of the violence.

I wanted equality and social justice; I did not want to lose anymore 'Wanjirus' to this nightmare. Pursuing knowledge helped me allay my culpabilities, but I also wanted to share this with the community and contribute positively. I attended a national secondary school and my classmates came from all over the country. Throughout my four years in high school, I learned the importance of inclusivity and acceptance. I tried as much as possible to learn about the different cultures and the language they use for communication; from Kalenjin to Kikuyu. This enhanced my ability to work with people efficiently without looking at their cultural backgrounds.

Like Mike the Chicken, I now live with the trauma of experiencing war and death at a young age. But I have also gained a lot of invaluable wisdom and insight in the aftermath. This experience taught me so much about overcoming negative experiences, finding my voice, facing my fears, and how to help others along the way. I am very prepared to achieve all my dreams. I will continue to dedicate myself to making the world a better place for everyone.

Community disruption

The advent of the COVID-19 pandemic in Kenya found me in school. The president of Kenya directed the indefinite closure of all schools. I went back to my village. Like many grade 12 students, I lost valuable classroom time for preparing for the KCSE. Back home, our sociocultural lifestyle was destabilized. More often than not, a usual cough would cause panic in the family. I tasked myself with the role of counseling and reassuring my family. Personally, I was saddened by the 'no handshake' rule as part of the measures against the virus. We lost the much-needed connection associated with a handshake grip during this time.

I also invested in farm work alongside my parents. We planted pumpkins during the period and sold them locally to help raise money for food for the family. I also herded my grandmother's cattle and milked them every morning. This instilled responsibility in me and I also learned new life skills.

Additionally, I had to find ways to increase my ability to stay on task with my books amid the distractions and also tutor my siblings. We could not afford the internet required for online education so we had to ground ourselves to read so as to be included academically.

The pandemic pushed me to a reflection on the future, what is within human control, and global preparedness for uncertainties. I got to appreciate the role of flexibility and adaptability in the achievement of a goal.

Additional information

Mustard seed project- volunteer

In the 2018 and 2019 November-December holidays, I volunteered for the Mustard Seed project in Kenya, a small UK charity providing quality education, health care, and a feeding program for poor children in Africa. I taught the 11-year-old children how to do basic computer tasks like using Microsoft excel and word. I also played the piano for them and organized their choir into Sopranos and Altos.

Book club

I founded and led a Book club at my high school in grade 9. I organized weekly meetings for book discussions and also specific monthly genres. By the end of grade 12, the club had a total of 254 active members. Additionally, in partnership with the school administration, I organized two monthly visits to the National Library in Nairobi. This improved the school's reading culture and the club is still currently active in the school.

UNESCO/STEM- Speaker and Teacher Volunteer

Due to my program, Elevate the Girl Child, in Kipchebor ward, I was invited as a speaker to a UNESCO/STEM program at Moi Tea Girls' Secondary School. This was immediately after high school while I was waiting for my KCSE results. This program was to encourage girls to take up

courses in STEM like Engineering. It was attended by more than 25 girls' schools in Kericho county. For the rest of the week, I volunteered to teach about computational methods using my AQUADUCCT (Ab Initio Quantum Dynamics Using Coupled Clustered in Time) project as a reference.

CHANGE THE WORLD MODEL UNITED NATIONS (CWMUN)

I qualified for the New York and Emirates CWMUN 2021 conferences after a highly selective process. I received a scholarship from the Associazione Diplomatici to attend the New York conference. I attended the conference in September 2021 and I was a delegate for Israel. I won best delegate of 2021.

RED CROSS & ST. JOHN AMBULANCE

I raised \$3,500 for hunger-stricken families in Turkana. As a St. John Ambulance cadet leader, I offered first aid services at inter-school and national sports competitions. I conducted 3 paramilitary boot camps for cadets in Kenya. I led my drill team in annual competitions and won 3 and received the honorary medal of service.

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DELFL Exam

I took the DELF B2 exam in grade 11 at Alliance Française and scored the highest mark in my school, (93.5/100). DELF is a diploma of French language studies and it is taken by non-native speakers. I received certification for my French language abilities from the French Ministry of Education.

Peer counselor

I was the peer counselor for my class from grade 9 through to grade 12. I listened to personal issues of most of my classmates and gave them advice where I could or referred them to the teacher counselor. This led me to receive the student's award as the 'Friendliest student' and 'Most Dignified student' in grade 12.

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Education progression

Details

Education progression details Did or will take gap year

Required explanation

Education progression

I took a one-year gap period due to financial reasons. Here are a few of my pursuits during this time:

Work (Paid)

I worked as a cashier at Gift Mart supermarket. Besides earning money to help my parents, I saved up for a Microsoft coding program. I learned the importance of customer service and flexibility. I also learned how to use point-of-sale systems to process orders and payments quickly.

Microsoft Developer Training

I learned how to design websites using HTML and CSS during this three-month course. At the end of the program, I had the opportunity to present my work at the TEMS Africa ICT Expo where I won an award for a prototype application to curb FGM. I also gained valuable networking skills through the program.

Community Impact

I taught sign language to students at Chepkutung Primary School in partnership with the head teacher. I interacted with students from different backgrounds and learned about their dreams. This helped me view the world in a different light and increased my urge to help the community. In addition, I expanded Elevate the girl child to the whole of Ainamoi and Belgut constituency in partnership with UNICEF.

Religious

On Sundays, I taught Biblical doctrines in Sunday school at Deliverance Church, Kericho. Every two weeks, we held a bible study for youth. This helped me grow spiritually.

Self-Enrichment

I used this time to explore my non-scholarly interests. I took Japanese classes on Duolingo and learned Hiragana and Katakana.

Columbia University questions

General

Preferred start term	Fall 2023
Admission plan	Regular Decision
Financial aid	Yes
School Specific Fee Waivers	Yes, I qualify for one of Columbia's fee waivers
Eligible FRLP	No
Certify authenticity	Yes, I have read and understand this statement.
High schools attended are listed	Yes, I have read and understand this statement.
Notify Columbia changes in application	Yes, I have read and understand this statement.
Will check status page	Yes, I have read and understand this statement.

More Information

Submit testing; if yes, ACT or SAT scores will not appear on PDF, but data will be sent to Columbia:	No
Portfolio	No
Academic integrity incidents	No
Community standards incidents	No

Academics

College or Engineering	Columbia College
First Area of Study	Physics
Second Area of Study	Computer Science
Third Area of Study	Applied Mathematics
Columbia-Juilliard Exchange	No

Optional additional test info

DELF EXAM (Diplôme d'études en langue française)

DELF B2

Reading - 23/25

Writing -22/25

Listening - 24/25

Speaking -24.5/25

Total Score: 93.5/100

DELF C1

Reading - 24/25

Writing - 24/25

Listening - 25/25

Speaking - 25/25

Total Score: 98/100

Activities

Activity 1	Community Service
Activity 2	Science and Engineering
Activity 3	Religious

Contacts

Previously applied	No
Contact 1	Conversation with admissions officer, current student, coach, alumna/alumnus, faculty member, Martha Wangechi
Contact 2	Columbia virtual information session
Contact 3	Viewbook or other publications
Contact 4	Other virtual event through Columbia admissions website
Call consent	I consent to be contacted by Columbia University at the mobile phone number provided below.
Mobile	+254.798187304

Family

Household Size	5
Parent different address	No
Number of parents/guardians	2
Parent/Guardian 1	Mother
Is this parent/legal guardian living?	Yes
First Name	Sharon
Last/Family/Surname	Terer
Birth country/region/territory	Kenya
Employment status	Unemployed
Occupation	Small-scale farmer
Position/title	N/A
Parent/Guardian 2	Father
Is this parent/legal guardian living?	Yes
First Name	Samwel
Last/Family/Surname	Terer
Birth country/region/territory	Kenya
Employment status	Unemployed
Occupation	Casual Tea picker
Position/title	N/A
Number of siblings	2
Sibling 1 First Name	Patience
Sibling 1 Last Name	Chebet
Sibling 1 Education Level	Graduated from high/secondary school (or equivalent)
Sibling 2 First Name	Lynn
Sibling 2 Last Name	Terer
Sibling 2 Education Level	Graduated from high/secondary school (or equivalent)
Sibling applied	No
Relatives attended member	No

Relative employed at No
member

Affirmations

By submitting this application, I affirm my understanding of and agreement to the statements found here: <http://www.commonapp.org/affirmations>.